



Letter Writing Quick Revision

The fast pass before the exam: the register table, memory tricks, 21 high-yield differences and the final revision sheet.

17 sections **61** letter & document types in detail **34** complete model letters **17** ready templates

130 glossary terms **135** practice questions

12

Formal vs Semi-formal vs Informal

Register = the level of formality of a letter. Decide it FIRST. The salutation, the close, the layout and the vocabulary all follow from it.

12.1 The high-yield comparison table HIGH-FREQUENCY

Feature	Formal	Semi-formal	Informal
A. The eight must-know features			
Receiver	Officials, offices, organisations, companies, banks, editors, unknown persons; superiors on official matters	People you know but are not close to: a teacher, neighbour, landlord or a friend's parent	Family members, relatives and close friends
Tone	Impersonal, polite, objective, to the point	Polite and respectful, but personal	Warm, friendly, conversational
Salutation	Dear Sir/Madam, / Sir, / Madam, (no name); Respected Sir, / Respected Madam, (superiors); Dear Mr. Raman, (a named person)	Dear Mr./Mrs./Ms./Dr. + surname, e.g. Dear Mr. Raman,	Dear Priya, / Dear Appa, / My dear Kavin,
Language	Standard formal English; formal words (request, inform, receive); no slang, SMS language or exclamation marks	Simple, courteous standard English; no slang	Everyday conversational English; personal news and feelings
Closing	Yours faithfully, (with Sir/Madam); Yours sincerely, (with a name)	Yours sincerely,	Your loving friend, / Your loving son, / Your loving daughter, / Yours affectionately, / With love,
Contractions	Never: I am, do not, cannot	Avoid them (safer in exams)	Allowed: I'm, can't, don't
Purpose	Official or business matters: applications, complaints, requests, orders, inquiries	Personal matters with people you know formally: thanks, apology, request, invitation, congratulations, condolence	Sharing news, feelings, invitations, advice and good wishes
Example	Complaint to the Commissioner about irregular garbage collection; leave letter to the Principal	Letter thanking your former teacher Mr. Raman for a recommendation letter; request to your landlord for repairs	Letter to your friend Priya about your holiday; letter to Appa asking for money for a school trip
B. Layout and extras			
Subject line	Compulsory (before the salutation in our layout)	Optional	Never
Receiver's address	Yes, after "To": designation, office, pin code	Yes: the receiver's name and address	No
Length	Short and to the point	Short to medium	Flexible; can be longer
Paragraphs	Usually three: why - what - what next (13.1)	Two to four short paragraphs	Free flow: greeting, news, good wishes
Sign-off name	Full name with initial (R. Karthik); designation for office letters; "ABC" / "XYZ" in exams if no name is given	Full name (R. Karthik)	First name only (Kavin)
Postscript (P.S.)	Avoid - put every point in the body	Rare; better avoided	Allowed for an afterthought (P.S. Say hello to Amma.)

DO NOT CONFUSE: A formal letter to a named person and a semi-formal letter both use "Dear Mr. Raman, ... Yours sincerely.". The difference is the PURPOSE: an official or business matter = formal; a personal matter with someone you know formally = semi-formal.

12.2 Decide the register in 10 seconds

Read the question and find the row that fits. The pair to use is given with each register.

Question to ask	If yes → register
Am I writing to an office, an official, a company, a bank or an editor - or to someone whose name I do not know?	Formal Dear Sir/Madam, (or Sir,) → Yours faithfully,
Is it an official or business matter, but the question names the receiver (e.g. Mr. Raman, the Sales Manager)?	Formal (named) Dear Mr. Raman, → Yours sincerely,
Am I a student or an employee asking my Principal or Head of Office for leave or permission?	Formal Respected Sir, / Respected Madam, → Yours faithfully, (students may also use Yours obediently,)
Is it an official matter (loan, admission, complaint) even though the receiver is my relative or friend?	Formal - the purpose decides. Write to the office, not to the person: Dear Sir/Madam, → Yours faithfully,
Am I writing about a personal matter to someone I know but am not close to (teacher, neighbour, landlord, a friend's parent)?	Semi-formal Dear Mr. Raman, → Yours sincerely,
Am I writing to a family member or a close friend about personal news?	Informal Dear Priya, / Dear Appa, → Your loving friend, / Your loving son,
Is one government officer writing personally to another to draw attention or speed up a matter?	Demi-official (D.O.) letter: Dear Shri Kumar, (Tamil Nadu: Dear Thiru Kumar,) → Yours sincerely, (see 13.8)
Is it a government communication between Ministries or Departments, or an order, circular or notice?	O.M. / Office Order / Circular / Notice: no salutation and no close (see Section 6)

12.3 Must-remember points

MUST REMEMBER: The salutation decides the close. No name (Sir/Madam) → Yours faithfully. A name (Dear Mr. Raman) → Yours sincerely. Family and friends → Your loving friend / Your loving son / Yours affectionately / With love.

MUST REMEMBER: Formal = receiver's address AND subject line, both compulsory. Semi-formal = receiver's name and address; subject optional. Informal = neither - only your short address and the date before "Dear Priya,".

MUST REMEMBER: Purpose and relationship decide the register, not the topic. Once chosen, keep ONE register from salutation to close: no contractions, slang or exclamation marks in a formal letter; no official phrases in a letter to a friend.

13 Letter-Writing Tricks

Short memory aids for the points examiners test most. Learn the trick, then check it against the table below it.

13.1 Letter structure: Why - What - What next

Every letter has a top (addresses, date, subject, salutation), a body and a bottom (close, name, Encl.). The top and bottom follow fixed patterns (13.2). The body is where most answers go wrong, so build it in three parts.

MEMORY TRICK: WHY - WHAT - WHAT NEXT. Paragraph 1 says WHY you are writing. The middle paragraph(s) give WHAT happened (the facts). The last paragraph says WHAT NEXT (the action you want). If a sentence answers none of the three, cut it.

Part	Question it answers	Useful starters	Example (street-light complaint)
Opening	WHY am I writing?	I wish to bring to your notice that ... / I am writing to apply for ... / With reference to your letter No. ... dated ...	I wish to bring to your notice that the street lights in Anna Street have not been working for three weeks.
Main (one or two paragraphs)	WHAT are the facts?	Dates, places, numbers, names; one idea per paragraph	The street is dark after 7 p.m. Last week an elderly resident fell in the dark near the water tank.
Closing	WHAT NEXT - what do I want?	I request you to ... / I would be grateful if you could ... / I look forward to your reply. / Thank you for your time.	I request you to arrange for the repair of the street lights as soon as possible.

The same trick works for informal letters: WHY = greeting and reason for writing (a reply, some news); WHAT = your news and feelings; WHAT NEXT = plans, good wishes and regards to the family.

EXAM TIP: Leave one blank line between paragraphs and do not indent (full block). Three clear paragraphs show planning before the examiner reads a word.

13.2 Formal letter sequence **HIGH-FREQUENCY**

MEMORY TRICK: S-D-R-S-S-B-C-S = "Sunday Dinner Remains Special - Sambar, Biryani, Curd, Sweet". Eight parts, top to bottom.

Letter	Trick word	Part of the letter	Model (/ = new line)
S	Sunday	Sender's address (no name)	12, Gandhi Road, / K.K. Nagar, / Madurai - 625 020
D	Dinner	Date	12 October 2026
R	Remains	Receiver's address	To / The Commissioner, / Madurai City Municipal Corporation, / Madurai - 625 001
S	Special	Subject	Subject: Complaint regarding irregular garbage collection in K.K. Nagar
S	Sambar	Salutation	Dear Sir/Madam,
B	Biryani	Body	Why - What - What next (13.1)
C	Curd	Complimentary close	Yours faithfully,
S	Sweet	Signature (name)	R. Karthik

Extras: a **Reference** line goes after the subject, only when you reply to earlier correspondence. **Encl.:** and **Copy to:** go below the name, only when needed.

MEMORY TRICK: Special comes before Sambar: the **Subject** comes before the **Salutation** in our layout. And your NAME is the last dish (Sweet), never the first - only your address goes at the top.

DO NOT CONFUSE: Two accepted variants exist. (1) In the traditional British / commerce-textbook layout, the subject comes AFTER the salutation. (2) The "From-To" format taught in many Tamil Nadu schools: "From" + your name and address, "To" + the receiver's address, salutation, subject, body, "Thanking you," then "Yours faithfully," and your name, with "Place:" and "Date:" at the bottom-left; school exams may also ask for the address on the envelope. Both are accepted. This book's model letters use the full-block S-D-R-S-S-B-C-S order; if a question asks for a particular format, follow the question.

13.3 Business transaction sequence

MEMORY TRICK: "Intelligent Queens Order Costly Diamonds; Delivery Includes Proper Receipts" = Inquiry, Quotation, Order, Confirmation, Dispatch, Delivery, Invoice, Payment, Receipt.

Step	Trick word	Letter or document	From → To	What it does
1	Intelligent	Inquiry	Buyer → Seller	Asks for prices, terms, a catalogue or samples
2	Queens	Quotation	Seller → Buyer	States prices, terms and conditions; valid for a stated period (firm offer)
3	Order	Order letter / Purchase Order (PO)	Buyer → Seller	Places the order; a PO is a formal numbered document
4	Costly	Confirmation (acceptance) of order	Seller → Buyer	Accepts the order and confirms the delivery date; once accepted, the PO is binding
5	Diamonds	Dispatch advice	Seller → Buyer	Says the goods have been sent; gives the LR / RR / B/L / AWB number
6	Delivery	Delivery	Seller (through the transporter) → Buyer	Goods arrive with a delivery challan; the buyer records them in a Goods Received Note (GRN)
7	Includes	Invoice (tax invoice)	Seller → Buyer	The bill: quantity, price, taxes, total and due date
8	Proper	Payment	Buyer → Seller	Pays by cheque or bank transfer, with a covering letter
9	Receipts	Receipt	Seller → Buyer	Acknowledges the payment

EXAM TIP: In real trade the invoice often travels with the goods or the dispatch advice; the trick gives the logical order. A **proforma invoice** is different: a preliminary bill sent BEFORE supply, for advance payment or import formalities.

EXAM TIP: Two side roads. Goods faulty → Complaint → Claim → Adjustment (13.7). Payment late → first reminder (polite) → second reminder (firmer) → final notice (warns of legal action).

13.4 Salutations

MEMORY TRICK: Distance decides the salutation. FAR (an office, no name) → Sir/Madam. MIDDLE (you know the name but are not close) → Mr./Mrs./Dr. + surname. NEAR (friends, family) → first name or relation (Appa, Amma). ABOVE you (Principal, boss) → Respected Sir/Madam.

Receiver	Salutation	Close	Register
Unknown person, company or organisation	Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	Formal
Official by designation (Collector, Commissioner, Branch Manager)	Sir, / Madam, / Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	Formal
Editor of a newspaper	Sir, / Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	Formal
Principal or Head of Office (your superior)	Respected Sir, / Respected Madam,	Yours faithfully, (students may also use Yours obediently,)	Formal
Named official or business contact	Dear Mr. Raman,	Yours sincerely,	Formal
Teacher, neighbour, landlord, a friend's parent	Dear Mr. Raman, / Dear Mrs. Raman,	Yours sincerely,	Semi-formal
Friend	Dear Priya, / My dear Kavin,	Your loving friend, / With love,	Informal
Parents	Dear Appa, / Dear Amma,	Your loving son, / Your loving daughter,	Informal
Younger relative	My dear Kavin,	Yours affectionately,	Informal
Government officer to officer (D.O. letter)	Dear Shri Kumar, (Tamil Nadu: Dear Thiru Kumar,)	Yours sincerely,	Demi-official
O.M., Office Order, Order, Notification, government Circular, Notice, internal Memo	None	None	Official forms

DO NOT CONFUSE: "Dear" OR "Respected" - never both together. Put a comma after every salutation; the colon (Dear Sir:) is American business style, not used in Indian exams. "Sir" goes in the salutation, never in the receiver's address.

13.5 Complimentary closes HIGH-FREQUENCY

MEMORY TRICK: Faceless (Sir/Madam) → Faithfully; Surname (Dear Mr. Raman) → Sincerely; Family → Lovingly / Affectionately. F goes with F, S goes with S. "Lovingly" stands for the loving closes: Your loving son, / Your loving daughter, / Your loving friend, / With love,

DO NOT CONFUSE: Faceless and Family both begin with F, but only Faceless gets Faithfully. A letter to Appa or Priya never ends with "Yours faithfully".

Close	Goes with	Used for
Yours faithfully,	Dear Sir/Madam, / Sir, / Madam, / Respected Sir, / Respected Madam,	Officials, organisations, editors, unknown persons, superiors
Yours sincerely,	Dear Mr. Raman, / Dear Shri Kumar,	Named persons in formal letters, all semi-formal letters, D.O. letters
Yours obediently,	Respected Sir, / Respected Madam,	Traditional: school students writing to the Principal
Your loving son, / Your loving daughter,	Dear Appa, / Dear Amma,	Parents
Your loving friend, / With love,	Dear Priya,	Friends
Yours affectionately,	My dear Kavin,	Family, especially elders writing to younger relatives
No close	No salutation	O.M., Office Order, Order, Notification, government Circular, Notice, internal Memo

MUST REMEMBER: Format of the close: capital first letter only, no apostrophe, a comma at the end, and the name on the next line (Yours faithfully, / R. Karthik). Variants you may see but should not use in model answers: "Sincerely yours," and "Sincerely," (American business), "Yours truly," (formal, also seen in letters to the editor).

EXAM TIP: "Thanking you," on a line of its own before the close is accepted Indian usage. The better modern style is a sentence inside the last paragraph: "Thank you for your time." Avoid "Thanking you in anticipation" - it is dated and presumes the answer.

13.6 Formal vocabulary

MEMORY TRICK: Upgrade the verb. In a formal letter, swap the everyday word for its formal partner: get → receive, ask → request, tell → inform. Keep the sentence short - only the word changes.

Informal word	Formal word	Example
get	receive / obtain	We received your quotation dated 2 October 2026.
ask	request / inquire	I request you to issue a duplicate hall ticket.
tell	inform	I wish to inform you that the goods have been dispatched.
need	require	We require 200 reams of A4 paper.
help	assist	Kindly assist us in tracing the missing parcel.
buy	purchase	We wish to purchase ten desktop computers.
give	provide	Please provide details of your delivery terms.
start	commence	The work will commence on 1 November 2026.
end	conclude	The training programme will conclude on 30 October 2026.
sorry	regret	We regret the inconvenience caused to you.
check	verify	Please verify the entries in my passbook.
fix	rectify / repair	Please rectify the error in my electricity bill.
send	forward / dispatch	I am forwarding my application through proper channel.
about	regarding / concerning	Subject: Complaint regarding delay in delivery
enough	sufficient	The present stock is not sufficient to meet the demand.
try	endeavour / attempt	We shall endeavour to deliver the goods by Friday.
answer	reply / respond	I look forward to your reply.
find out	ascertain	Please ascertain the cause of the delay.
put off	postpone	The meeting has been postponed to 20 October 2026.
keep	retain	Please retain a copy for your records.
mistake	error	We regret the error in our invoice.
money back	refund	Please refund the amount of Rs. 2,500.
job	post / position	I wish to apply for the post of Junior Assistant.
a lot of	many / a large number of	A large number of residents have complained.

13.7 Inquiry vs quotation vs order vs complaint vs claim vs adjustment HIGH-FREQUENCY

MEMORY TRICK: **ASK → PRICE → BUY → GRUMBLE → GET PAID → PUT RIGHT.** The two P-words, PRICE and PUT RIGHT, are the seller's letters (P = the Provider). The other four come from the buyer.

Letter	Who writes	Trick word	Meaning
Inquiry (enquiry)	Buyer	ASK	Asks for information: prices, terms, a catalogue or samples. "Inquiry letter" and "enquiry letter" are both accepted.
Quotation	Seller	PRICE	The seller's statement of prices, terms and conditions, sent in reply to an inquiry (before the order). It has a validity period (firm offer).
Order	Buyer	BUY	A letter placing an order. A Purchase Order (PO) is a formal numbered document issued by the buyer; it is binding once the seller accepts it.
Complaint	Buyer	GRUMBLE	Reports a problem: defect, delay, shortage or wrong goods.
Claim	Buyer	GET PAID	Demands a specific remedy or compensation: refund, replacement or price reduction.
Adjustment	Seller	PUT RIGHT	The seller's reply that settles a complaint or claim: full grant, partial grant, or a polite refusal with reasons.

DO NOT CONFUSE: A COMPLAINT only reports the problem; a CLAIM asks for a specific remedy. An ADJUSTMENT letter is written by the SELLER, never by the buyer. A QUOTATION is a firm price; an ESTIMATE is an approximate cost; a TENDER is a formal (often sealed) offer made in response to an invitation, usually from public bodies. More pairs: see Section 15.

EXAM TIP: Spelling: in the British tradition "enquiry" means asking for information and "inquiry" means a formal investigation; American English uses "inquiry" for both. Either spelling is accepted for the letter - use one consistently.

13.8 Government forms tricks

Full formats are in Section 6. These tricks fix the salutation, the close and the key phrase of each form.

Form	Memory trick	Salutation → Close	Key features and use
Official letter	"I am Directed" = Official	Sir, / Madam, → Yours faithfully,	From a Government office to other governments, bodies, officials or the public; begins "I am directed to ..."; signed with designation
Demi-official (D.O.) letter	D.O. = Dear Officer → sincerely	Dear Shri Kumar, (Tamil Nadu: Dear Thiru Kumar,) → Yours sincerely,	Officer to officer; personal, friendly tone; first person singular; to draw personal attention, expedite a matter or exchange views; D.O. No. at the top
Office Memorandum (O.M.)	O.M. = Other Ministry, third person, no salutation	None → None	Between Ministries / Departments (also with attached offices and employees); "The undersigned is directed to ..."; signed with name and designation
Office Order	Office Order stays inside the Office	None → None	Internal administrative instructions: distribution of work, grant of leave, postings within the office
Order	Order = M & M: Money and Misconduct	None → None	Financial sanctions, disciplinary matters, etc.
Notification	Notification = in the Gazette	None → None	Publication of rules, orders, appointments, promotions, etc. in the Official Gazette
Resolution	Resolution Resolves policy (also in the Gazette)	None → None	Public announcement of important policy decisions or the appointment of committees or commissions; published in the Gazette
Circular	A Circular goes round in a circle	None → None	The same information sent to many offices or persons
Endorsement	ENDorsement = at the END	Not a letter	Government: a note at the foot of a communication forwarding copies ("Copy forwarded to ... for information / necessary action") or returning a paper to the sender. Banking: a signature on the back of a cheque or other negotiable instrument to transfer it.

MEMORY TRICK: "I am directed" (first person) = **Official letter**. "The undersigned is directed" (third person) = **O.M.**

MEMORY TRICK: Both go to the Gazette, but a **Notification** Names people and rules (appointments, promotions, rules), while a **Resolution** Resolves policy (policy decisions, committees, commissions).

MEMORY TRICK: Tamil Nadu: **G.O.** (Government Order) comes from the Government - the Secretariat departments. **Proceedings** come from Heads of Departments and District officers: "Proceedings of the District Collector, ... Present: Thiru ..., Rc. No. ..., Dated ..., Sub: ..., Ref: ..., ORDER: ...".

MEMORY TRICK: Honorifics: Shri - Smt. - Kumari (Central Government) = Thiru - Thirumathi (Tmt.) - Selvi (Tamil Nadu Government) = Mr. - Mrs. - Miss. "Hon'ble" for Ministers and judges; "M/s." (Messrs) for firms, e.g. M/s. Kaveri Traders.

MUST REMEMBER: Only two government forms carry a salutation and a close: the official letter (Sir → Yours faithfully) and the D.O. letter (Dear Shri Kumar → Yours sincerely). "Through proper channel" = an employee's application to a higher authority goes through the immediate superior, with a "Through: ..." line above or below the addressee.

13.9 One-page cheat card

Situation	Salutation	Close	Key opening phrase
Leave or permission from the Principal / Head of Office	Respected Sir, / Respected Madam,	Yours faithfully, (students: Yours obediently,)	I request you to grant me leave for two days, from ... to ..., as ...
Complaint to a civic authority (Commissioner, Collector, Police)	Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	I wish to bring to your notice that ...
Letter to the Editor	Sir, / Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	Through the columns of your newspaper, I wish to draw the attention of the authorities concerned to ...
Job application	Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	In response to your advertisement in The Hindu dated ..., I wish to apply for the post of ...
Inquiry or order to a firm	Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	Please send us your latest price list and terms for ... / Please supply the following items as per your quotation No. ... dated ...

Situation	Salutation	Close	Key opening phrase
Complaint or claim to a seller	Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully,	We regret to inform you that the goods received against our Order No. ... dated ... are damaged.
Request to your bank (cheque book, stop-payment, change of address)	Dear Sir/Madam, (to the Branch Manager)	Yours faithfully,	I hold a savings account (No. XXXXXXXX4521) in your branch and request you to ...
Government official letter	Sir, / Madam,	Yours faithfully,	I am directed to ...
Named person, semi-formal (teacher, neighbour, landlord)	Dear Mr. Raman,	Yours sincerely,	I am writing to thank you for ...
Friend or family	Dear Priya, / Dear Appa,	Your loving friend, / Your loving son,	I was very happy to receive your letter. / I hope you are all keeping well.

D.O. and O.M. patterns: see 13.8. No name or address in the question? Write "Examination Hall" and sign as "ABC" (11.9).

15 High-Yield Differences

Each pair below is compared in a Basis table and ends with one memory trick. The ten pairs marked **HIGH-FREQUENCY** should be revised first. 15.22 puts all 21 pairs in one table for last-minute revision. Related sections: business and transactional letters - Sections 3 and 5; banking letters - Section 4; government forms - Section 6; formal, semi-formal and informal letters in full - Section 12.

How to write a "distinguish between" answer: give a one-line definition of each term; then write 4 to 6 points of difference, each point on the SAME basis for both terms (meaning, sender, receiver, stage, purpose, format, effect); end with one example of each. A two-column table is the clearest layout. For a short answer, the one-line difference in 15.22 is enough.

15.1 Inquiry vs Enquiry **HIGH-FREQUENCY**

Basis	Inquiry	Enquiry
Meaning (British tradition)	A formal investigation into a matter, usually ordered by an authority; serious and official - it may end in findings, a report or punishment	Asking for information; a simple, routine question with no official consequence
Common phrases	order / hold / conduct an inquiry; an inquiry into the matter; an inquiry report	make an enquiry; reply to an enquiry; "Thank you for your enquiry of 5 October 2026."
Who makes it	A court, commission, committee, the police or a government department	Anyone - a customer, buyer, student or traveller who wants to know something
Verb	<i>inquire into</i> = investigate: "The committee will inquire into the accident."	<i>enquire about</i> = ask about: "She enquired about the train timings."
American English	"Inquiry" is used for BOTH meanings	Rare - "enquiry" is chiefly British
Examples	A judicial inquiry into a fire accident; a Commission of Inquiry; a departmental inquiry against an officer	A price enquiry to a supplier; an enquiry about admission; the enquiry counter at a railway station
In letter writing	"Inquiry letter" - accepted; this book uses it	"Enquiry letter" - equally accepted (British and Indian usage)

MEMORY TRICK: Inquiry = INvestigation; Enquiry = Everyday asking - but "inquiry letter" and "enquiry letter" are both correct.

15.2 Inquiry letter vs Quotation letter

Basis	Inquiry letter	Quotation letter
Meaning	A letter asking a supplier for information - price list, catalogue, samples, discount, delivery and payment terms	The seller's statement of prices, terms and conditions for the goods asked about
Written by → sent to	Prospective buyer (a trader, institution or individual) → manufacturer, wholesaler or other seller	Seller → prospective buyer
Stage	First step of a business deal	Second step - sent in reply to the inquiry, before the order
Purpose	To collect information and compare suppliers before buying	To offer the goods clearly and attractively and win the order
Main contents	Goods needed, approximate quantity, date required, questions on price, discount, delivery and payment terms; a request for a catalogue or samples	Price per unit, trade discount, cash discount, taxes, packing and delivery terms (Ex-works, FOR, FOB, CIF), payment terms, delivery period, validity period

Basis	Inquiry letter	Quotation letter
Effect	No commitment on either side - the buyer is not bound to buy	A firm offer - the seller commits to the quoted prices for the validity period; the buyer is still free not to order
Example line	"Please send us your latest price list for A4 notebooks and your terms of payment."	"We quote Rs. 45 per notebook, less 10% trade discount. This quotation is valid for 30 days."

MEMORY TRICK: I comes before Q - the buyer's Inquiry asks, the seller's Quotation answers.

15.3 Quotation vs Invoice HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	Quotation	Invoice
Meaning	The seller's statement of prices, terms and conditions offered to a prospective buyer	The bill issued by the seller for goods supplied (or services rendered)
Stage	BEFORE the order - in reply to an inquiry	AFTER the order - when the goods are supplied or dispatched (it often travels with the goods or follows by post or e-mail)
Issued by → to	Seller → prospective buyer	Seller → buyer (customer)
Purpose	To offer goods and win the order	To state the amount due and ask for payment; it is also the seller's record of the sale and the buyer's proof of purchase
Main contents	Prices, discounts, taxes, delivery and payment terms, validity period	Invoice number and date, names and addresses of seller and buyer (with GSTIN), description, quantity, rate, taxes, total amount, due date; often "E&OE" (Errors and Omissions Excepted)
Financial effect	Nothing is payable; the buyer may accept it or ignore it	Payment becomes due by the stated due date; both parties enter it in their accounts
Related terms	Estimate = approximate cost; Tender = formal (often sealed) offer made in response to an invitation, usually from public bodies	Proforma invoice = preliminary bill sent BEFORE supply (for advance payment or import formalities); it does not replace the final invoice

MEMORY TRICK: Quotation = "this is what it WILL cost" (before the order); Invoice = "this is what you OWE" (after supply).

15.4 Order vs Purchase Order

Basis	Order (order letter)	Purchase Order (PO)
Meaning	A letter in which the buyer places an order for goods	A formal, numbered document issued by the buyer to order goods
Form	Ordinary business letter - salutation, paragraphs, complimentary close	Printed or computer-generated form - PO number, date, table of items, printed terms and conditions, authorised signature
Used by	Small firms, shopkeepers, individual buyers; one-off orders	Companies, government offices and institutions that have a purchase department; large or repeated orders
How items are shown	In sentences or a short list inside the letter	In a fixed table: item, description, quantity, unit price, amount, total
Identification	May carry a Ref. No.; later letters refer to "our order dated ..."	Unique PO number, quoted on the invoice, the delivery challan and all later letters
Legal / record value	The buyer's offer to buy; binding once the seller accepts it or supplies the goods	Binding once accepted by the seller; also the buyer's official record - matched with the invoice and the Goods Received Note (GRN) before payment
Example	"Please supply 500 A4 notebooks at Rs. 45 each as per your quotation dated 5 October 2026."	"PO No. 2026/117 dated 12 October 2026 - A4 notebooks, 500 nos. @ Rs. 45 = Rs. 22,500 - delivery by 30 October 2026"

MEMORY TRICK: An order letter TALKS in paragraphs; a PO LISTS in a numbered form - every PO is an order, but not every order is a PO.

15.5 Complaint vs Claim

Basis	Complaint letter	Claim letter
Meaning	The buyer reports a problem - defect, delay, shortage, wrong goods, poor service	The buyer demands a specific remedy or compensation for a loss
Focus	The PROBLEM - what went wrong	The REMEDY - refund, replacement, price reduction or compensation
Written by → sent to	Buyer/customer → seller; also a citizen → an authority (civic complaint)	Buyer → seller; also consignee → carrier (transport company), insured person → insurance company

Basis	Complaint letter	Claim letter
Timing	As soon as the problem is noticed	With or after the complaint, once the loss is known and can be valued; insurance and carrier claims must be made within the time allowed in the policy or contract
Main contents	Order/invoice details, nature of the problem, a request to look into it	Order/invoice details, loss suffered, the exact remedy or amount demanded, proof (invoice copy, photographs, survey report)
Tone	Firm but polite; states facts without anger, insults or threats	Firm, precise and specific; may fix a reasonable time limit for settlement
Example line	"Twenty of the 500 notebooks supplied against our order No. 117 were water-damaged."	"Please replace the 20 damaged notebooks or credit Rs. 900 to our account."

MEMORY TRICK: Complaint says WHAT went wrong; Claim says WHAT you want - in practice one letter often does both.

15.6 Complaint vs Adjustment

Basis	Complaint letter	Adjustment letter
Meaning	A letter reporting a problem with goods or service	The seller's reply that settles a complaint or claim
Written by → sent to	Buyer/customer → seller	Seller → the buyer/customer who complained
Stage	Opens the matter - after faulty, late or short goods are received	Closes the matter - after the seller has checked the complaint
Purpose	To get the problem corrected	To settle the matter fairly, keep the customer's goodwill and avoid losing future business
Main contents	Order/invoice details, the problem, the action requested	Thanks for the letter, regret or apology, cause of the problem, the decision - full grant, partial grant or polite refusal with reasons - and an assurance for the future
Tone	Firm, factual and polite	Courteous and positive; a refusal is explained tactfully, never rudely
Example line	"Twenty notebooks in your consignment of 12 October 2026 were water-damaged."	"We regret the damage. Twenty fresh notebooks are being sent to you today at our cost."

MEMORY TRICK: The buyer COMPLAINS, the seller ADJUSTS - the complaint is the problem, the adjustment is the settlement.

15.7 Credit note vs Debit note HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	Credit note	Debit note
Meaning	A note telling the buyer that his account has been CREDITED - the amount he owes is REDUCED	A note telling the other party that his account has been DEBITED
Issued by → to	SELLER → buyer	BUYER → seller, when returning goods or claiming a deduction; a seller may also send one to the buyer to charge an extra amount
Common reasons	Goods returned by the buyer; overcharge in the invoice; allowance for damaged or short goods; a discount or rebate allowed after the invoice	Goods returned to the seller; overcharge or shortage claimed; (seller's debit note) undercharge in the invoice
Effect on the buyer's dues	REDUCES the amount the buyer owes	Buyer's debit note: claims a deduction from the amount payable. Seller's debit note: INCREASES the amount the buyer owes
Entry in the issuer's books (goods returned)	Seller debits Sales Returns (Returns Inward) and credits the buyer's account; recorded in the Sales Returns Book	Buyer debits the seller's account and credits Purchases Returns (Returns Outward); recorded in the Purchases Returns Book
Side note: GST law	Issued by the supplier when the invoice charged too much or goods are returned	Also issued by the supplier - when the invoice charged too little
Example	"Credit Note No. CN-45: your account has been credited with Rs. 900 for 20 damaged notebooks returned."	"Debit Note No. DN-12: your account has been debited with Rs. 900 for 20 damaged notebooks returned to you."

MEMORY TRICK: Goods go back: the Buyer sends a Debit note, the Seller sends a Credit note ("B-D, S-C") - and a credit note always cuts the buyer's bill.

15.8 Credit letter vs Letter of Credit HIGH - FREQUENCY

Basis	Credit letter	Letter of Credit (L/C)
Meaning	Any business letter ABOUT credit - asking for, checking, granting or refusing credit	A BANK's written undertaking to pay the seller when specified documents are presented
Written / issued by	A buyer, a seller or a trade referee	The issuing bank, at the request of the buyer/importer (the applicant)
Sent to	A supplier, customer, trade referee or bank	The seller/exporter (the beneficiary), usually through an advising bank in the seller's country
Purpose	To obtain or decide on trade credit - e.g. 30 or 60 days to pay	To assure payment to a seller who does not know the buyer well - used mainly in foreign trade (e.g. an importer in Chennai buying machines from a German exporter)
Kinds	Request to open a credit account; credit (status) inquiry to referees; letter granting credit; letter refusing credit. (A bank's "credit advice" only tells a customer that his account has been credited.)	Irrevocable, confirmed, sight (paid when the documents are presented), usance (paid after a fixed period)
Parties	Buyer and seller (plus referees)	Applicant, issuing bank, beneficiary, advising / confirming bank
Financial effect	No guarantee of payment - only a request, information or a decision	The bank's own promise to pay against documents - the seller relies on the bank, not on the buyer

MEMORY TRICK: A credit letter TALKS about credit; a Letter of Credit is a BANK'S PROMISE to pay.

15.9 Reference letter vs Recommendation letter HIGH - FREQUENCY

Basis	Reference letter	Recommendation letter
Meaning	A general statement of facts about a person's character, conduct or work	A letter that actively endorses (supports) a person for a SPECIFIC job, admission, scholarship or award
Written by → addressed to	A former employer, principal or teacher → often "To Whom It May Concern" - no particular reader	A teacher, guide or supervisor who knows the candidate's work closely → a specific recipient - an employer, a selection committee or an admissions office
Purpose	To confirm facts - period of work or study, duties, conduct	To persuade the reader to select the person
Tone	Neutral and factual	Warm, positive and persuasive
Content	Dates, post or class, main duties, general character and conduct; usually no comparison with others	Specific achievements and qualities matched to the post or course, often with a comparison ("one of the best students I have taught"); a clear statement such as "I strongly recommend her"
Use	General - the same letter can be shown for many purposes	Written for one purpose - one post, course or award
Example line	"Mr. S. Arun worked in our office as an Assistant from June 2022 to May 2026. His work and conduct were satisfactory."	"I strongly recommend Ms. R. Kavya for admission to your M.A. English programme; she was the best student in her batch."

MEMORY TRICK: Reference = "this is what she is" (facts, for anyone); Recommendation = "please select her" (support, for someone specific).

15.10 Bank reference vs Credit reference

Basis	Bank reference	Credit reference
Meaning	A bank's statement about its customer's account and general standing	Information about a person's or firm's creditworthiness - the ability and willingness to pay debts
Given by	The customer's own bank	Trade referees (other suppliers who have given credit) or credit information companies (e.g. CIBIL)
Given when	Only on request - a bank keeps its customer's affairs confidential	On request, when a supplier or lender is deciding whether to give credit
Based on	How the bank account has been maintained and operated	Actual payment record - credit allowed, dues, delays or defaults; a credit report or score
Nature of the reply	Brief, general and cautious; balances and confidential details are not disclosed	More specific - credit limit allowed, payment habits, amounts outstanding
Used for	Checking the general standing of a new customer or business partner, e.g. before opening a credit account	Deciding whether to grant credit or a loan, how much and for how long

Basis	Bank reference	Credit reference
Example line	"The firm has maintained a current account with us since 2015; its dealings have been satisfactory."	"They have bought from us on 30 days' credit for five years and have always paid on time."

MEMORY TRICK: Bank reference = what your BANK says about your account; Credit reference = what your CREDITORS (suppliers, CIBIL) say about your paying habits.

15.11 Circular vs Notice HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	Circular	Notice
Meaning	The same information sent (circulated) to many individual recipients	A formal announcement displayed publicly, or a formal legal intimation to a person
How it reaches people	Each recipient gets a copy - by post, by e-mail, or in a file passed round for signature	Put up on a notice board or published in a newspaper or on a website; a legal notice is served on the person concerned
Audience	A defined group - offices, staff, members, customers (often a distribution list)	The public or everyone concerned; a legal notice - one specific person
Issued by	Government offices, heads of institutions, companies (to branches, dealers or customers)	Institutions, offices, companies, courts; an advocate on behalf of a client (legal notice)
Purpose	To pass on instructions, information or changes - e.g. new office timings, change of address, opening of a new branch	To announce a meeting, event, holiday, tender, auction or examination schedule; a legal notice demands or warns
Format	Government circular: number, date, "CIRCULAR", subject, body, signature and designation - no salutation, no close. A business circular letter has "Dear Sir/Madam," and "Yours faithfully,"	Public notice: name of the institution, heading "NOTICE", date, title, short body, signature, name and designation - no salutation, no close
Example line	"All Heads of Department are requested to send the staff attendance statement for October 2026 by 5 November 2026."	"The college will remain closed on 2 October 2026 on account of Gandhi Jayanti."

MEMORY TRICK: A Circular CIRCULATES - a copy goes round to each person; a Notice is NOTICED - one copy is put up for all to see.

15.12 Memorandum vs Office Memorandum HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	Memorandum (memo)	Office Memorandum (O.M.)
Meaning	A short internal communication within an organisation	The formal government form for communication between Ministries/Departments
Used in	Any organisation - company, bank, school, hospital, office	Government - Ministries and Departments
Direction	Inside one organisation - manager to staff, section to section, staff to manager	Between Ministries/Departments; also with attached offices and with employees
Person and style	Direct and brief; first person or plain instructions	Third person - "The undersigned is directed to ..."
Format	Heading MEMO; To, From, Date and Subject lines; short body; initials or signature; no salutation, no close	O.M. No., name of the Ministry/Department, place and date, heading "OFFICE MEMORANDUM", subject, body; signed with name and designation; addressee at the bottom-left; no salutation, no close
Typical uses	Instructions, reminders, requests, short reports, asking a staff member for an explanation	Asking for or supplying information; conveying decisions and instructions of the Government to other Departments and to employees
Example line	"To: All Branch Staff; From: Branch Manager; Date: 12 October 2026; Subject: Working hours during audit week"	"The undersigned is directed to refer to this Ministry's O.M. of even number dated ... and to say that ..."

MEMORY TRICK: A memo stays INSIDE one organisation; an O.M. travels BETWEEN government departments, in the third person.

15.13 Memorandum vs Letter HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	Memorandum (memo)	Letter
Meaning	A short internal communication within an organisation	A written message usually sent OUTSIDE the organisation - to firms, customers, officials, the public or friends
Audience	Colleagues and staff of the same organisation	Outsiders - customers, suppliers, government offices, individuals

Basis	Memorandum (memo)	Letter
Format	MEMO heading; To / From / Date / Subject block; no inside address, no salutation, no complimentary close	Sender's address or letterhead, date, inside address, subject, salutation, body, complimentary close, signature
Length and tone	Short and direct; often in numbered points; one topic per memo	Can be longer; complete and courteous; tone depends on the type (formal, semi-formal or informal)
Signature	Initials or signature of the sender	Full signature with name (and designation) below the complimentary close
Delivery	Internal mail, office file or e-mail - no envelope or postage needed	Post, courier, hand delivery or e-mail
Example opening	"All section heads will attend a staff meeting on 16 October 2026 at 4 p.m. in the conference hall." (no "Dear", no "Yours")	"Dear Sir/Madam, Thank you for your order No. 117 dated 12 October 2026."

MEMORY TRICK: Memo = IN-house, with no "Dear" and no "Yours"; Letter = goes OUT, with salutation and close.

15.14 Petition vs Representation

Basis	Petition	Representation
Meaning	A formal request to an authority for redress (remedy) or action; also a legal application to a court	An individual's formal statement to an authority presenting a grievance or seeking reconsideration of a decision
Made by	Often signed by many - residents, villagers, members of an association (one person may also petition)	Usually one individual - often an employee about his own service matter
Addressed to	An authority - Collector, Commissioner, Minister, the Government; a court (e.g. a writ petition)	A higher authority - usually in the writer's own department or organisation, or the Government
Subject matter	Common or public problems - road, water supply, street lights, bus service; legal relief in a court	Personal grievance - seniority, promotion, transfer, pay fixation; a request to reconsider an order
Route	Submitted directly to the authority (e.g. at the Collector's grievance day meeting); in a court, filed as per the court's rules	Through proper channel - via the immediate superior (a "Through: ..." line)
Structure	Facts of the problem, the relief requested (in a court: the "prayer"), names, addresses and signatures of all petitioners	Facts, reference to the order or rule, grounds for reconsideration, the specific relief requested; one signature with designation
Example line	"We, the undersigned residents of Anna Nagar, request that street lights be provided on 4th Main Road."	"I request that my seniority be refixed and my case for promotion be reconsidered."

MEMORY TRICK: Petition = many People, a Public problem; Representation = one person's own case, sent through proper channel.

15.15 Application vs Request

Basis	Application	Request
Meaning	A formal request for something one is eligible for - job, leave, admission, loan, licence	Any asking for information, permission, help or action
Scope	Narrow - one special kind of request	Wide - includes applications and many other kinds of asking
Format	Often a prescribed form or fixed format; certificates, ID proof or photographs enclosed; an employee's application to a higher authority goes through proper channel	Any suitable letter or e-mail; usually no prescribed form
Eligibility	The applicant must meet stated conditions - age, qualification, service, income	No eligibility conditions; the receiver may agree or decline
Outcome	A formal decision - selection, sanction, admission, grant of leave, or rejection	Information, permission, help or action - as the receiver decides
Examples	Job application, leave application, application for admission, loan application, application for a licence or scholarship	Request for a catalogue, for an extension of time, for permission to use the school ground, for a meeting
Example line	"I wish to apply for the post of Junior Assistant advertised in The Hindu."	"I request you to extend the last date for fee payment by one week."

MEMORY TRICK: Every application is a request, but not every request is an application - you APPLY only for what you are ELIGIBLE for.

15.16 Enclosure vs Annexure

Basis	Enclosure	Annexure
Meaning	A separate document sent in the same envelope with a letter	A document added at the end of a main document, numbered and forming part of it

Basis	Enclosure	Annexure
Relation to the main document	Separate - it travels with the letter but stands on its own	Part of the main document - the two are read together
Used with	Letters and applications sent by post or by hand	Reports, agreements, tenders, government orders, project proposals
Numbering / marking	Listed below the signature as "Encl.: 1. ... 2. ..."; the body says "I enclose ..."	Numbered and titled - Annexure I, Annexure II (or A, B); the text refers to it: "(see Annexure II)"
Position	Loose sheets placed with the letter; the Encl. list is at the bottom-left of the letter	After the last page of the main document, each annexure starting on a new page with its heading
Typical items	Copies of certificates, a cheque or demand draft, an invoice copy, photographs	Tables, statements, lists of names, maps, specimen forms, copies of earlier orders
Example	"Encl.: 1. Copy of SSLC mark sheet 2. Demand draft for Rs. 500"	"The list of selected candidates is given in Annexure I."

MEMORY TRICK: ENClosure = ENClosed in the ENvelope (separate); ANNEXure = ANNEXed, joined to the document (part of it).

15.17 Attachment vs Enclosure

Basis	Attachment	Enclosure
Meaning	A file sent with an e-mail (or a paper clipped or stapled to a document)	A separate document sent in the same envelope with a letter
Medium	Mostly electronic - a digital file travels with the e-mail	Paper - placed loose in the envelope with the letter
Typical items	Resume (PDF), scanned certificates, photographs, spreadsheets, presentations	Certificate copies, a cheque or demand draft, photographs, a brochure
How it is mentioned	"Please find attached ..." / "I have attached ..."; an "Attachment:" line may be added	"Please find enclosed ..." / "I enclose ..."; an "Encl.:" line below the signature
Check before sending	Right file, readable format (PDF is safest for documents), reasonable size, clear file name	Every item in the Encl. list is actually inside the envelope
Common mistake	Writing "please find attached" and forgetting to attach the file	"Please find enclosed herewith" - outdated; write "Please find enclosed" or "I enclose"
Example	"Please find attached my resume in PDF format."	"I enclose a demand draft for Rs. 500 and two passport-size photographs."

MEMORY TRICK: The e-mail ATTACHES; the envelope ENCLOSES.

15.18 Acknowledgement vs Confirmation

Basis	Acknowledgement	Confirmation
Meaning	Confirms RECEIPT only - of a letter, order, payment, application or goods. (Spelling: acknowledgement - British; acknowledgment - American; both correct.)	Confirms AGREEMENT - that something will go ahead as stated (an order, booking, meeting or arrangement)
Commitment	None on the matter itself - "received; under consideration"	Commits the sender - the terms, date or arrangement are now fixed
Timing	Immediately on receiving something	After a decision is taken or the terms are agreed
Purpose	To assure the sender that the item has arrived safely; avoids doubt, delay and repeat sending	To remove uncertainty and put the agreed terms on record
Typical phrases	"We acknowledge with thanks the receipt of your letter dated ..."; "This is to acknowledge receipt of ..."	"We are pleased to confirm your order No. ..."; "This is to confirm that ..."
Common forms	Acknowledgement slip for an application; receipt for a payment; acknowledgement of an order	Order confirmation; hotel or ticket booking confirmation; confirmation of a meeting or interview date
Example line	"We have received your order No. 117 dated 12 October 2026; it is being processed."	"We confirm your order No. 117 for 500 notebooks at Rs. 45 each, for delivery by 30 October 2026."

MEMORY TRICK: Acknowledgement = "we GOT it"; Confirmation = "it is ON - agreed".

15.19 Reminder vs Notice

Basis	Reminder	Notice (final / demand notice)
Meaning	A polite follow-up about a pending action, payment or reply	A formal, firmer intimation that may carry legal consequences
Stage (collection series)	First reminder (polite) → second reminder (firmer)	Final notice / demand - sent when the reminders have failed
Tone	Courteous; assumes the delay is an oversight	Firm, serious and formal; states the consequence clearly but stays polite
Contents	Reference to the earlier letter or invoice, what is pending, a request to act	Exact amount or action demanded, a final deadline, the consequence (legal action, stoppage of credit or supply)
Sent by	Seller, creditor, office or anyone awaiting a reply	Creditor, bank or landlord - often through an advocate (legal notice)
Legal effect	None - it keeps the relationship friendly	May be the first step to legal action - e.g. the demand notice for a dishonoured cheque under Section 138 of the Negotiable Instruments Act, 1881, sent within 30 days of receiving the bank's return memo
Example line	"This is a reminder that our invoice No. 245 for Rs. 22,500, due on 30 September 2026, is still unpaid."	"Unless Rs. 22,500 is paid within 15 days of receipt of this notice, we shall be compelled to take legal action."

MEMORY TRICK: A Reminder REQUESTS (a polite nudge); a Notice WARNS (the last chance before action).

15.20 Formal vs Semi-formal HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	Formal letter	Semi-formal letter
Meaning	A letter written for an official, business or public purpose	A letter to a person we know, but not closely, on a matter that is partly personal and partly official
Written to	Officials, offices, companies, editors, unknown persons - usually by designation	Known persons in a respectful relationship - a former teacher, neighbour, landlord, colleague, a friend's parent
Salutation	"Dear Sir/Madam," / "Sir," / "Respected Sir,"	"Dear Mr. Raman," / "Dear Mrs. Sundaram," (title + surname)
Complimentary close	"Yours faithfully," ("Yours sincerely," when a named person is addressed as "Dear Mr. Raman,")	"Yours sincerely,"
Subject line and address	Subject line needed; receiver's designation and full address	Subject line optional; receiver's name and address
Tone and language	Impersonal and precise; no personal news, no contractions	Respectful but warm; a short personal touch is allowed; no slang, contractions avoided
Examples	Job application, complaint to the Corporation Commissioner, letter to the editor, letter to a bank manager	Letter to a former teacher seeking advice, to a landlord about repairs, to a neighbour about a shared problem, thanking a friend's father

MEMORY TRICK: Formal writes to a POST ("Sir/Madam ... Yours faithfully"); semi-formal writes to a PERSON you know ("Dear Mr. Raman ... Yours sincerely").

15.21 D.O. letter vs Official letter HIGH-FREQUENCY

Basis	D.O. (demi-official) letter	Official letter
Meaning	A personal, friendly letter from one officer to another on an official matter - "demi" means half: half official, half personal	A formal letter from a Government office to other governments, bodies, officials or the public
Addressed to	An officer by name (officer to officer)	An authority by designation, another government, an organisation or a member of the public
Purpose	To draw personal attention, to expedite (speed up) a matter, or to exchange views or information	To convey decisions, sanctions, instructions, replies and information formally - the normal form for Government correspondence with other governments, bodies and the public
Person and tone	First person singular ("I"); personal, friendly tone	Formal and impersonal; the officer writes for the Government - "I am directed to ..."
Salutation → close	"Dear Shri Kumar," (Tamil Nadu: "Dear Thiru Kumar,") → "Yours sincerely,"	"Sir," / "Madam," / "Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"

Basis	D.O. (demi-official) letter	Official letter
Layout	"D.O. No." and the writer's name and designation at the top; addressee's name and address at the bottom-left; signed personally	Letter number at the top; "To" and the addressee's designation and address at the top; subject line; signed with name and designation
Example opening	"I am writing to seek your personal help in completing the land records for the new bus stand at Erode."	"I am directed to inform you that the Government has sanctioned Rs. 5 lakh for the repair of the school building."

MEMORY TRICK: D.O. = "Dear Shri" + "I" + "Yours sincerely" (officer to officer); Official = "Sir" + "I am directed" + "Yours faithfully".

15.22 Master summary table

One line per pair - enough for a short answer. For self-testing, cover the right-hand column and recall each difference aloud.

Pair	One-line difference
Inquiry vs Enquiry	Inquiry = formal investigation; enquiry = asking for information (British tradition); American English uses "inquiry" for both.
Inquiry letter vs Quotation letter	Inquiry = the buyer asks for prices and terms; quotation = the seller's reply giving prices, terms and a validity period, before the order.
Quotation vs Invoice	Quotation = price offer BEFORE the order; invoice = the bill AFTER supply, which makes payment due.
Order vs Purchase Order	Order letter = an order placed in letter form; PO = the buyer's formal numbered document, binding once accepted by the seller.
Complaint vs Claim	Complaint reports the problem; claim demands a specific remedy - refund, replacement, price reduction or compensation.
Complaint vs Adjustment	Complaint = the buyer's letter about a problem; adjustment = the seller's reply that settles it (full grant, partial grant or polite refusal with reasons).
Credit note vs Debit note	Credit note = seller to buyer, reduces what the buyer owes; debit note = buyer to seller for returns or deductions (a seller's debit note charges an undercharge).
Credit letter vs Letter of Credit	Credit letter = any letter about trade credit; L/C = a bank's written undertaking to pay the seller against specified documents.
Reference letter vs Recommendation letter	Reference = neutral statement of facts, often "To Whom It May Concern"; recommendation = persuasive endorsement for a specific post, admission or award, to a specific reader.
Bank reference vs Credit reference	Bank reference = a bank's statement on its customer's account and standing; credit reference = creditworthiness report from trade referees or credit information companies (e.g. CIBIL).
Circular vs Notice	Circular = copies sent to many individual recipients; notice = displayed publicly, or served as a formal legal intimation.
Memorandum vs Office Memorandum	Memo = short internal note in any organisation; O.M. = the formal government form between Ministries/Departments - third person, no salutation, no close.
Memorandum vs Letter	Memo = internal, To/From/Subject block, no salutation or close; letter = usually external, full format with salutation and close.
Petition vs Representation	Petition = request for redress or action, often signed by many (also to a court); representation = one person's grievance or plea for reconsideration, through proper channel.
Application vs Request	Application = formal request for something one is eligible for, often in a prescribed format; request = any asking - every application is a request, not the reverse.
Enclosure vs Annexure	Enclosure = separate document in the same envelope; annexure = numbered document at the end of a main document, forming part of it.
Attachment vs Enclosure	Attachment = file sent with an e-mail (or clipped); enclosure = separate document sent in the same envelope with a letter.
Acknowledgement vs Confirmation	Acknowledgement confirms RECEIPT only; confirmation confirms AGREEMENT - that it will go ahead as stated.
Reminder vs Notice	Reminder = polite follow-up on a pending matter; notice = firm, formal intimation that may lead to legal action (final demand).
Formal vs Semi-formal	Formal = official purpose, "Dear Sir/Madam ... Yours faithfully"; semi-formal = a known person, "Dear Mr. Raman ... Yours sincerely".
D.O. letter vs Official letter	D.O. = officer to officer, personal, "Dear Shri Kumar ... Yours sincerely"; official = "Sir ... I am directed to ... Yours faithfully".

MUST REMEMBER: Who sends what in trade - Buyer → Seller: inquiry, order / purchase order, complaint, claim, debit note (for goods returned). Seller → Buyer: quotation, invoice, adjustment letter, credit note. Issuing bank → Seller (beneficiary): letter of credit. Normal sequence: Inquiry → Quotation → Order → Invoice; if something goes wrong: Complaint / Claim → Adjustment.

MUST REMEMBER: Salutation test - NO salutation and NO close: Office Memorandum, internal memo, government circular, public notice (also Office Order, Order, Notification). "Sir," / "Madam," (official letter) or "Dear Sir/Madam," (other formal letters) + "Yours faithfully,". "Dear Shri Kumar," (Tamil Nadu: "Dear Thiru Kumar,") + "Yours sincerely,". D.O. letter. "Dear Mr. Raman," + "Yours sincerely,": semi-formal letter, and a formal letter to a named person.



Final Revision Sheet

Last-minute revision: five tables, ten golden rules and one box. Every entry follows the house conventions used throughout this book. For explanations and model letters, go back to the section named in each introduction line.

17.1 50 Most Important Letter-Writing Terms

Parts of a letter (1-16), registers and letter types (17-19), government correspondence (20-32), business and banking (33-50). Details: Sections 1, 4, 6 and 7.

No.	Term	One-line meaning
1	Letterhead	The printed heading of a firm or office: name, address, phone and email (and GSTIN for a firm).
2	Sender's address	The writer's address at the top-left; the name is NOT written here but below the close.
3	Date line	The date of writing, in the style "12 October 2026".
4	Ref. No.	The sender's file or letter number, written above the date in business letters and used to trace correspondence.
5	Inside address	The receiver's name or designation and full address, written below "To".
6	Attention line	"Kind Attention: ..." - directs a letter addressed to a firm to a particular person or department.
7	Subject line	"Subject:" + a short noun phrase stating the purpose; before the salutation; no full stop ("Sub:" is accepted).
8	Reference line	"Reference: Your letter No. ... dated ..." - used only when referring to earlier correspondence.
9	Salutation	The greeting before the body, e.g. "Dear Sir/Madam,"; always followed by a comma.
10	Complimentary close	The polite phrase before the signature, e.g. "Yours faithfully,".
11	Signature block	Signature, name and, in official or business letters, designation.
12	Enclosure (Encl.)	A document sent with the letter, listed below the signature.
13	Copy to / CC	Other persons who receive a copy of the letter (CC = carbon copy or courtesy copy).
14	Postscript (P.S.)	A short note added below the signature; avoid it in formal letters.
15	Full-block format	A layout in which every line starts at the left margin; used for all model letters in this book.
16	Register	The level of formality of a letter: formal, semi-formal or informal.
17	Formal letter	A letter to an official, an organisation or an unknown person, in a fixed format and formal language.
18	Semi-formal letter	A letter to a known person (not close) on a personal or partly official matter: "Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,".
19	Informal letter	A personal letter to family or friends; no subject line and no receiver's address; contractions allowed.
20	Official letter	From a Government office to other governments, bodies, officials or the public; begins "I am directed to ..."; signed with designation.
21	Demi-official (D.O.) letter	An officer-to-officer letter in a personal tone and the first person; D.O. No. at the top; "Dear Shri Kumar," → "Yours sincerely,".
22	Office Memorandum (O.M.)	Communication between Ministries/Departments; third person ("The undersigned is directed to ..."); no salutation, no close.
23	Office Order	Internal administrative instructions: distribution of work, grant of leave, postings within the office.
24	Order	Used for financial sanctions, disciplinary matters, etc.
25	Notification	Publication of rules, orders, appointments, promotions, etc. in the Official Gazette.
26	Resolution	Public announcement of important policy decisions or of the appointment of committees or commissions; published in the Gazette.
27	Circular	The same information sent to many offices or persons.
28	Notice	An announcement displayed or published for the information of a group or the public; no salutation, no close.

No.	Term	One-line meaning
29	Endorsement	Government: a note at the foot forwarding copies or returning a paper to the sender. Banking: a signature on the back of a cheque to transfer it.
30	Government Order (G.O.)	An order issued by a Secretariat department of the Tamil Nadu Government.
31	Proceedings	The format used by Heads of Departments and District officers in Tamil Nadu: Present, Rc. No., Dated, Sub, Ref, ORDER.
32	Through proper channel	An employee's application to a higher authority, sent through the immediate superior (a "Through: ..." line).
33	Inquiry / enquiry letter	A letter asking for information such as prices, terms or availability; both spellings are accepted.
34	Quotation	The seller's statement of prices, terms and conditions in reply to an inquiry; valid for a stated period (firm offer).
35	Tender	A formal (often sealed) offer in response to an invitation, usually from public bodies.
36	Purchase Order (PO)	A formal numbered document issued by the buyer; binding once accepted by the seller.
37	Proforma invoice	A preliminary bill sent before supply, for advance payment or import formalities.
38	Invoice (tax invoice)	The seller's bill for goods supplied: quantity, price, taxes, total and due date.
39	Complaint letter	The buyer reports a problem: defect, delay, shortage or wrong goods.
40	Claim letter	The buyer demands a specific remedy: refund, replacement or price reduction.
41	Adjustment letter	The seller's reply that settles a complaint or claim: full grant, partial grant or polite refusal with reasons.
42	Credit note	Issued by the seller; reduces the amount the buyer owes (goods returned, overcharge, allowance).
43	Debit note	Issued by the buyer when returning goods or claiming a deduction; a seller may also send one to charge an undercharged amount.
44	Letter of Credit (L/C)	A bank's written undertaking, issued at the buyer's request, to pay the seller when specified documents are presented.
45	Bank reference	A bank's statement about its customer's account and general standing, given on request.
46	Credit reference	Information about creditworthiness from trade referees or credit information companies (e.g. CIBIL).
47	Collection series	First reminder (polite) → second reminder (firmer) → final notice (warns of legal action).
48	Stop-payment	The account holder's instruction to the bank not to pay a cheque; give the cheque number, date, amount and payee.
49	E&OE	Errors and Omissions Excepted - printed on invoices and similar documents so that errors can be corrected later.
50	M/s.	Messrs - written before the name of a firm, e.g. "M/s. Kaveri Traders".

17.2 50 Most Useful Formal Phrases

Modern, correct phrases only: openings (1-15), requests (16-25), enclosures and references (26-30), complaints (31-35), business replies (36-43), government (44-45) and closings (46-50). Details: Section 8.

No.	Phrase	Use
1	I am writing to inform you that ...	Opening: giving information
2	I am writing to request ...	Opening: making a request
3	I am writing to bring to your notice ...	Opening: reporting a problem (complaint)
4	I wish to draw your attention to ...	Pointing out an issue to an authority
5	This is to inform you that ...	Giving formal information or an announcement
6	With reference to your letter No. ... dated ...,	Replying to earlier correspondence
7	Thank you for your letter dated ...	Opening a reply politely
8	In response to your advertisement in The Hindu dated ..., I wish to apply for the post of ...	Job application
9	Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to draw the attention of the authorities to ...	Letter to the Editor
10	On behalf of the residents of ..., I wish to ...	Writing on behalf of a group
11	I am directed to ...	Official letter from a Government office
12	The undersigned is directed to ...	Office Memorandum (third person)
13	We acknowledge receipt of your letter dated ...	Confirming that a letter has arrived
14	We are pleased to inform you that ...	Conveying good news
15	We regret to inform you that ...	Conveying bad news or a refusal
16	I would be grateful if you could ...	Polite request
17	I would appreciate it if you could ...	Polite request (modern)

No.	Phrase	Use
18	I request you to ...	Direct formal request
19	Please take the necessary action.	Asking an office to act
20	I request you to look into the matter and take suitable action.	Complaint: asking for action
21	Please treat this matter as urgent.	Stressing urgency
22	Please let me know whether ...	Asking for information
23	Please send us your latest price list and terms of payment.	Business inquiry
24	I request you to grant me leave for ... days, from ... to ...	Leave letter
25	I request you to stop payment of cheque No. ... dated ... for Rs. ...	Stop-payment letter to a bank
26	Please find enclosed ...	Mentioning an enclosure
27	I enclose ...	Mentioning an enclosure (shortest modern form)
28	A copy of ... is enclosed for your reference.	Enclosure with its purpose
29	As stated in my letter dated ...,	Referring to your own earlier letter
30	Further to our telephone conversation today,	Following up a phone call in writing
31	I regret to state that ...	Stating a problem politely
32	Despite repeated requests, ...	Showing that a problem continues
33	Some of the goods were found damaged on arrival.	Business complaint about goods
34	We request you to replace the damaged items as early as possible.	Claim: asking for a remedy
35	I hope this matter will receive your prompt attention.	Ending a complaint politely but firmly
36	We apologise for the inconvenience caused.	Apology (adjustment letter)
37	We regret the delay in ...	Apologising for a delay
38	We have arranged to replace the damaged goods free of cost.	Adjustment: granting a claim
39	We are pleased to place an order for the following items:	Order letter
40	Our terms of payment are 30 days from the date of invoice.	Stating credit terms
41	This quotation is valid for 30 days from its date.	Validity of a quotation (firm offer)
42	This is to remind you that our invoice No. ... dated ... remains unpaid.	First reminder (collection series)
43	Unless the amount is received by ..., we shall be compelled to take legal action.	Final notice (collection series)
44	Copy forwarded to ... for information and necessary action.	Endorsement (government)
45	Receipt of this letter may be acknowledged.	Official letter: asking for an acknowledgement
46	I look forward to hearing from you.	Closing: expecting a reply
47	Thank you for your time and consideration.	Closing thanks inside the last paragraph
48	Please do not hesitate to contact me if you need any further information.	Offering further help
49	I hope you will consider my request favourably.	Closing a request
50	I would be grateful for an early reply.	Asking for a quick reply

17.3 25 Most Important Letter Types

Register, salutation-close pair and a key opening phrase for each type. Details: Sections 2-6 and 12.

No.	Letter type	Register	Salutation → Close	Key opening phrase
1	Letter to a friend	Informal	"Dear Priya," → "Your loving friend,"	"I was delighted to receive your letter."
2	Letter to a parent	Informal	"Dear Appa," → "Your loving son," / "Your loving daughter,"	"I am doing well here and hope everyone at home is fine."
3	Letter to a teacher or neighbour (known person)	Semi-formal	"Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,"	"I am writing to thank you for ..."
4	Letter of congratulations to a known person	Semi-formal	"Dear Mrs. Narayanan," → "Yours sincerely,"	"Please accept my warm congratulations on ..."
5	Leave letter to the Principal or Head of Office	Formal	"Respected Sir," → "Yours faithfully," (school students may also use "Yours obediently,")	"I request you to grant me leave for two days, from 14 to 15 October 2026, as ..."

No.	Letter type	Register	Salutation → Close	Key opening phrase
6	Job application	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"In response to your advertisement in The Hindu dated ..., I wish to apply for the post of ..."
7	Resignation letter (to a named manager)	Formal	"Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,"	"I wish to resign from my post of ... with effect from ..."
8	Complaint to a civic authority	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"I am writing to bring to your notice the ..."
9	Letter to the Editor	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," (or "Sir,") → "Yours faithfully,"	"Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to draw the attention of the authorities to ..."
10	Business inquiry letter	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"We are interested in ... and request your latest price list and terms of payment."
11	Quotation	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"Thank you for your inquiry dated ... We are pleased to quote as follows:"
12	Order letter	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"We are pleased to place an order for the following items:"
13	Complaint letter (buyer to seller)	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"We regret to inform you that some of the goods received on ... are damaged."
14	Claim letter	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"We request you to replace the damaged items or refund Rs. ..."
15	Adjustment letter	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully," (named customer: "Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,")	"Thank you for your letter dated ... We apologise for the inconvenience caused."
16	Collection (reminder) letter	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"This is to remind you that our invoice No. ... dated ... for Rs. ... remains unpaid."
17	Bank letter: stop-payment	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"I request you to stop payment of cheque No. ... dated ... for Rs. ..."
18	Bank letter: request (change of address, new cheque book)	Formal	"Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"I request you to update the address in my savings account No. XXXXXXXX4521."
19	Official letter (Government)	Formal	"Sir," or "Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"	"I am directed to ..."
20	Demi-official (D.O.) letter	Formal (personal tone)	"Dear Shri Kumar," (Tamil Nadu: "Dear Thiru Kumar,") → "Yours sincerely,"	"I would like to draw your personal attention to ..."
21	Office Memorandum	Formal	No salutation / no close	"The undersigned is directed to ..."
22	Office Order	Formal	No salutation / no close	"The following distribution of work is ordered with immediate effect:"
23	Circular (government)	Formal	No salutation / no close	"All Heads of Departments are requested to ..."
24	Notification	Formal	No salutation / no close	"In exercise of the powers conferred by section ... of the ... Act, ..."
25	Notice	Formal	No salutation / no close	"This is to inform all ... that ..."

17.4 20 Most Confusing Terms

The key difference in one cell. Full comparison tables: Section 15.

No.	Pair	Key difference
1	Yours faithfully vs Yours sincerely	Faithfully: after "Dear Sir/Madam," "Sir," or "Respected Sir," (officials, organisations, editors, unknown persons). Sincerely: after "Dear Mr. Raman," (named person), in all semi-formal letters and in D.O. letters.
2	Enquiry vs Inquiry	British tradition: enquiry = asking for information; inquiry = formal investigation. American English uses "inquiry" for both; "inquiry letter" and "enquiry letter" are both accepted.
3	Quotation vs Estimate	Quotation: firm prices, terms and conditions with a validity period. Estimate: approximate cost only.
4	Quotation vs Tender	Quotation: the seller's reply to a buyer's inquiry. Tender: a formal (often sealed) offer in response to an invitation, usually from public bodies.
5	Order letter vs Purchase Order	Order letter: a letter placing an order. Purchase Order: a formal numbered document issued by the buyer; binding once accepted by the seller.

No.	Pair	Key difference
6	Proforma invoice vs Invoice	Proforma invoice: a preliminary bill sent before supply (for advance payment or import formalities). Invoice: the bill for goods supplied - quantity, price, taxes, total and due date.
7	Complaint letter vs Claim letter	Complaint: reports a problem (defect, delay, shortage, wrong goods). Claim: demands a specific remedy (refund, replacement, price reduction).
8	Claim letter vs Adjustment letter	Claim: written by the buyer. Adjustment: the seller's reply that settles it (full grant, partial grant or polite refusal with reasons).
9	Credit note vs Debit note	Credit note: issued by the seller; reduces what the buyer owes. Debit note: issued by the buyer when returning goods or claiming a deduction (a seller may also send one for an undercharge). Side note: under GST law both are issued by the supplier.
10	Credit letter vs Letter of Credit	Credit letter: a business letter about credit (opening a credit account, status inquiry, granting or refusing credit). Letter of Credit: a bank's undertaking to pay the seller against specified documents.
11	Credit advice vs Debit advice	Intimation, usually from a bank, that an account has been credited (credit advice) or debited (debit advice).
12	Bank reference vs Credit reference	Bank reference: a bank's statement on its customer's account and general standing. Credit reference: creditworthiness information from trade referees or credit information companies (e.g. CIBIL).
13	Stop-payment vs Cheque dishonour	Stop-payment: the account holder tells the bank not to pay a cheque. Dishonour: the bank returns the cheque unpaid with a return memo; the payee may then send a legal demand notice under Section 138 of the Negotiable Instruments Act, 1881, within 30 days of receiving the memo.
14	FOB vs CIF	FOB: the seller's cost and risk end when the goods are loaded on board the ship at the port of shipment. CIF: the seller pays cost, insurance and freight up to the destination port.
15	Official letter vs D.O. letter	Official: "Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully,"; begins "I am directed to ..."; signed with designation. D.O.: "Dear Shri Kumar," → "Yours sincerely,"; personal tone, first person; D.O. No. at the top.
16	Office Memorandum vs Office Order	O.M.: communication between Ministries/Departments, in the third person. Office Order: internal instructions within an office (distribution of work, leave, postings).
17	Office Order vs Order	Office Order: internal administrative matters. Order: financial sanctions, disciplinary matters, etc.
18	Notification vs Resolution	Notification: rules, orders, appointments and promotions published in the Gazette. Resolution: important policy decisions or the appointment of committees or commissions (also published in the Gazette).
19	Circular vs Notice	Circular: the same information sent to many offices or persons. Notice: displayed or published for the information of a group or the public. Neither a government circular nor a notice has a salutation or a close.
20	Endorsement (government) vs Endorsement (banking)	Government: a note at the foot forwarding copies ("Copy forwarded to ... for information / necessary action") or returning a paper to the sender. Banking: a signature on the back of a cheque or other negotiable instrument to transfer it.

17.5 10 Letter Formats to Memorise

Read each line from left to right; every model letter in this book is in full-block format with one blank line between blocks. Details: Sections 6 and 9.

No.	Letter	Order of parts
1	Formal letter	Sender's address → Date → To → Receiver's designation and address → Subject → Reference (only if needed) → "Dear Sir/Madam," → Opening paragraph → Main paragraph(s) → Closing paragraph → "Yours faithfully," → Name → Encl. / Copy to (if any)
2	Semi-formal letter	Sender's address → Date → Receiver's name and address → Subject (optional) → "Dear Mr./Mrs. Surname," → Body → "Yours sincerely," → Full name
3	Informal letter	Sender's address (short) → Date → Salutation ("Dear Priya,") → Body → Close ("Your loving friend,") → First name (no subject line, no receiver's address)
4	Business letter	Letterhead (firm name in capitals, address, phone, email, GSTIN) → Ref. No. → Date → Inside address → Kind Attention (optional) → Subject → Salutation → Body → Complimentary close → "For FIRM NAME" (optional) → Name → Designation → Encl. → CC
5	Letter to the Editor	Sender's address → Date → To → The Editor, newspaper, city → Subject → "Dear Sir/Madam," (or "Sir,") → Body (issue, facts, suggestions) → "Yours faithfully," → Name
6	Job application	Sender's address → Date → To → Employer's designation and address → Subject: Application for the post of ... → "Dear Sir/Madam," → Body (post and advertisement, qualifications and experience, request for an interview) → "Yours faithfully," → Name → Encl.: CV and copies of certificates
7	Bank letter	Sender's address → Date → To → The Branch Manager, bank and branch address → Subject (with the masked account number) → "Dear Sir/Madam," → Body (account details, request, reason) → "Yours faithfully," → Name (signature as in bank records) → Encl. (if any)
8	D.O. letter	Sender's name, designation and office with D.O. No. (at the top) → Date → "Dear Shri Kumar," (Tamil Nadu: "Dear Thiru Kumar,") → Body (first person, personal tone) → "Yours sincerely," → Signature and name → Addressee's name and address (bottom-left)

No.	Letter	Order of parts
9	Office Memorandum (no salutation, no close)	File No. → Government of India, Ministry / Department → Place and date → OFFICE MEMORANDUM → Subject → Body in the third person ("The undersigned is directed to ...") → Signature, name and designation → To: addressee(s) (bottom-left) → Copy to
10	Leave letter	Sender's address → Date → To → The Principal / Head of Office, with address → Subject: Request for leave → "Respected Sir," (or "Dear Sir/Madam,") → Body (dates, reason, request) → "Yours faithfully," (school students may also use "Yours obediently,") → Name (with class or designation)

17.6 10 Golden Rules of Formal Letter Writing

1. **Exam identity rule.** If the question gives no name or address, write "Examination Hall" as the address and sign as "ABC" (or "XYZ"); if the question gives them, use exactly those. Never reveal your real identity.
2. **Pair the salutation and the close.** "Dear Sir/Madam," / "Sir," / "Respected Sir," → "Yours faithfully,"; "Dear Mr. Raman," and D.O. letters → "Yours sincerely,"; family and friends → "Your loving ...". Write "Yours" with a capital Y and no apostrophe, and put a comma after both the salutation and the close.
3. **Write a precise subject line before the salutation.** "Subject:" + a short noun phrase with no full stop, e.g. "Subject: Complaint regarding irregular garbage collection in K.K. Nagar".
4. **Build a three-part body.** Opening (why you are writing) → main (facts and details) → closing (the action you want).
5. **No contractions or slang.** Also no exclamation marks, SMS language or emoji in a formal letter; use modern phrases, not outdated ones.
6. **Write the date as "12 October 2026".** Avoid all-numeric dates such as 12/10/2026, which are ambiguous.
7. **One purpose per letter.** Do not mix a complaint with an unrelated request; write a separate letter for each.
8. **Polite but firm tone.** State facts, not anger; even a final reminder or a strong complaint stays courteous.
9. **Check names, designations and addresses.** Use the receiver's exact designation, office, city and pin code ("Madurai - 625 001"), and spell every name correctly.
10. **End with a clear request or action.** Say exactly what you want done and, where relevant, by when.

17.7 Final MUST REMEMBER Box

MUST REMEMBER: "Dear Sir/Madam," → "Yours faithfully," but "Dear Mr. Raman," → "Yours sincerely,"; the subject line comes before the salutation and has no full stop; O.M., Office Order, Notification, government Circular and Notice have no salutation and no close; the credit note is issued by the seller and reduces what the buyer owes; date every letter "12 October 2026"; no name in the question → "Examination Hall" and "ABC".

Letter Writing Master Notes — TNPSC General English. Model letters use the full-block exam format; where textbooks differ, the accepted variant is noted.

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